

Rep. Tom Emmer on Kudlow

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LARRY KUDLOW:

But first up, we welcome back to the show Majority Whip, Tom Emmer from the great state of Minnesota. Tom, good to see you. So okay. So I happen to be on air in the Sandra Smith show when the news broke and Speaker Mike Johnson announced your opposition to the Senate bill. Now, as I understand it, let me just say this and then you can come right at me. The Senate bill, unfortunately, I mean, fortunately stopped the Democrats attempt to destroy ice. Okay. The so-called democratic reforms. However, it's not funding. And I didn't know this. There's a lot of non-core, I'll call it professional back office. And I also have to add, if this is right, sex trafficking, child trafficking, areas of ice and so forth, DHS that were not funded in the one big, beautiful bill. And therefore, to the House's reckoning, the Senate version is unacceptable, unacceptable because there are no appropriations for these parts of the DHS that are very important. If we expect to keep the border closed and deport illegals and criminals. Now, you tell me if that story is about am I interpreting what Mike Johnson was saying about an hour, a little more than an hour ago.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, that's one of the details, Larry. It's great to be with you. Thank you for pointing out the actual facts. Yes, human trafficking would essentially be shut down if this were passed into law. Literally, what we've done in the House, we passed full funding three times in a row. In fact, as late as yesterday, we passed it out of the House with four to six Democrats supporting what we were doing. And what we got back at 3 a.m. this morning, in the dark of night, we get a bill back that literally says there will be zero funding to the Customs and Border Patrol and to ICE, the Immigration and Customs Enforcement people. And everybody on the other side now wants to say that it's fully funded. That's not what they were saying before. And they were taking a victory lap as it came over here because all the senators left town. I guarantee you, if the senators would have read this very short bill last night, they would have seen that it says a big zero for funding of these operations. And what that means, it will never come back.

LARRY KUDLOW:

Well, that may be. You're probably going to be right about that, what you just said at the end. And that's most unfortunate. But look, I don't think it's just no funding for ICE. I mean, after all, the core functions of ICE and the customs and border and related, those were funded. Those were put into the one big, beautiful bill.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Actually, that's not accurate.

LARRY KUDLOW:

Well, that's what everyone has always said. I don't understand. This is.

REP. TOM EMMER:

And that's what we have been. This has been clarified over the last couple of weeks that, in fact, these functions that you're talking about, the core functions were not the subject of the big, beautiful bill. The big, beautiful bill included the technology improvements, the border, finishing the border wall, those types of things. And yes, there was funding in there for certain immigration customs enforcement activities. But I'll give you an example there. It's not just shutting down the human trafficking operations of these departments, but Customs and Border Patrol is also required to handle trade as it comes into our ports. That is going to be shut down. Look, we've passed this thing over and over. The president and Republicans ran on sealing our southern border and making sure that we deport criminal, illegal aliens, murderers, rapists, terrorists, pedophiles, drug dealers. And that's exactly what we're going to keep doing. And what the speaker said this morning is we're not going to be part of a deal that would literally shut that down. Democrats are still for open borders and protecting illegal criminal aliens over the safety and security of American citizens. House Republicans aren't going to put up with that. And that's why we're going to send back a bill that literally will fund these agencies with a CR for 60 days and all the back pay in it. And we'll let the Senate do their job and get this thing ironed out so that we can put the safety and security of the American public first.

LARRY KUDLOW:

But meanwhile, OK, so the president signed an executive order also about an hour or two ago with a good statement on it. TSA will be paid and they'll get their back pay. OK, so that's good. Unfortunately, other parts of DHS will be shut down. It's continued. I'm worried about cybersecurity because that's one of evil Iran's specialty to Maison. But also you have Coast Guard and FEMA, all these Coast Guard, I mean, in a wartime anyway. You know that story as well as I do, and I think so do our viewers. The point is you're going to try to get a vote, I guess, today or tonight, but the Senate is gone. So whether the Senate comes back, I don't know. All right. That's separate issue. I haven't I have not had a chance to talk to anybody in the Senate because this story broke so fast. So anyway, we're going to be in a difficult position, let's say, with TSA in the airports. Just take that over the Easter vacation.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Actually, it shouldn't have to be that way, Larry. We're going to vote on this as soon as it gets out of rules. The rules committee started about a half hour ago. As soon as they're done, then the hope is that we're going to move this and get this passed. And look, if the Senate really cares about taking care of the American people and their safety, making sure that these TSA agents can count on their paychecks going forward, take care of our Coast Guard. Some of these kids are serving right now over in the Middle East without a guarantee of being paid. I mean, this list goes on and on. If they are serious about putting Americans first and American safety first, Larry, they can you see this on Monday morning as soon as we open for business again. And then they can come back to the table when they get back from wherever they decided to go last night and get their darn job done.

LARRY KUDLOW:

Well, listen, the senators may not get here so fast because there are long lines in the airports. We'll see. That's a joke. Just kidding. I'm just making things up a little bit. But I will say this to me, Tom Emmer, to me, and I've said this many times on the air, you know, the dream, the mission dream of the Democratic Party is open borders and end ICE, defund ICE and ICE. Just that. So I know that's what they want. I don't care. That's what many of them say. I mean, Hakeem Jeffries the other day said the ICE agents who were going to help out in the airports were going to murder people. He actually said that. So I get it. And I agree with your point of view. I think the details here are going to be very important. But anyway, it's very brave and courageous. You got to stand up for your principles. Tom Emmer, great state of Minnesota. Thank you for coming on. We appreciate it

very, very much.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you.

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